

THE MEDIEVAL WORLD

900 - 1400

★ DEFINITION

- "Medievalism" is a later historical construct used to describe the period between collapse of Western Roman empire & Renaissance

★ MYTHS & MISCONCEPTIONS

- Dark Ages = cultural stagnation ~~X~~ not accurate
- Medieval = regressive / brutal
- Eurocentric = ignore other civilization
- Oversimplifies diverse social & political realities

★ MEDIEVAL IN EURASIA (EUROPE + ASIA)

- Defined by its temporal & historical linearity
- Idea of Charismatic leadership
 - ↳ People drew namesake from the past ⇒ collective form of empowerment (ใบสั่งเจ้า)
 - ↳ Becomes embodiment of grander + more sacred charismatic entity → increase legitimacy through heredity
- Caliphate system
- Sinosphere → ex. Wu Zetian
- Ancestry politics: relied on legitimacy by presenting themselves as living embodiment of promised 'golden age' in religious + political thinking

★ 3 MEDIEVAL LATIN WORLD CONCEPTS

① AUCTARITAS (บารมีศักดิ์สิทธิ์)

- moral legitimacy that holds with society

church
Pope
emperor
classical text

- legacy from ancient Rome

↳ adopted by Christian theology + Holy Roman empire

- Rulers / elites sought to derive auctaritas from church / classical texts → legitimize their rules + policies

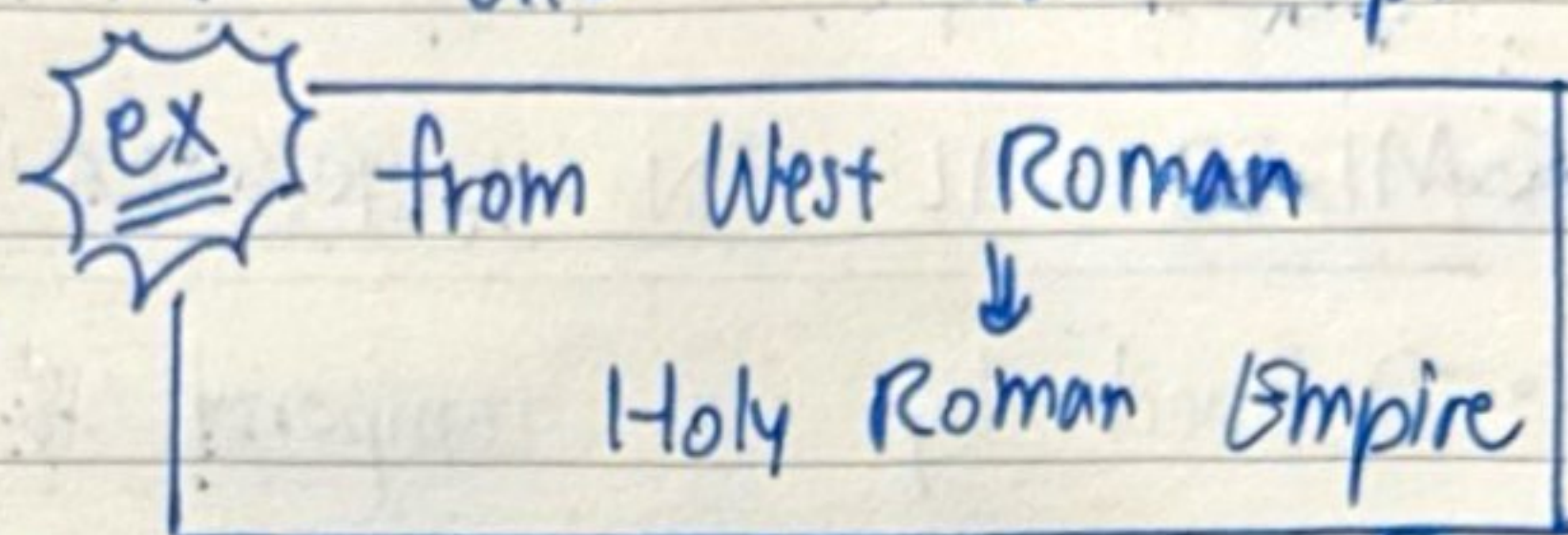
↳ บารมีมาจากศาสนา → ศาสนาเป็นต้นฉบับของบารมี

- underpinned legal & moral order of medieval world

② TRANSLATIO IMPERII (Transfer of empire)

- Imperial authority is transferred from one dominant empire to another

↳ empire legacy heredity!



- legitimacy of rules, continuity of power

↳ unify diverse territories

CHARLEMAGNE
gained translatio imperii
by earning support from
Pope Leo II

③ TRANSLATIO STUDII (Transfer of knowledge)

- Transfer of learning, scholarship + cultural achievements from one civilization to another

- Intellectual & cultural advancement more geographically + temporally

- Provide cultural legitimacy (ex. shared values, norms)

↳ linking intellectual + cultural achievements to esteemed traditions

- Justify revival of classical learning & incorporations of knowledge

- Establish uni & educational systems

↳ centre for transfer & expansion of knowledge

★ NON LATINISED CONCEPTS OF POWER

TRANSLATIO IMPERII

① TIANMING (mandate of Heaven)

- developed during Zhou Dynasty but was highly developed during Ming Dynasty
- Rulers are judged by justly & effective governance
 - ↳ responsible for restoring social harmony & prosperity
 - ↳ harmony & prosperity are what is expected from rulers
- Divine authority intervenes during abnormal time

② CHAKRAVARTIN (UNIVERSAL RULER)

- Hindu + buddhist traditions
- Ideal universal ruler who governs ethically over entire world
- Principles of Dharma (law & duty) one should uphold

HINDUISM

- sovereign who hold sway over the world
- His/Her holding Dharma

BUDDHISM

- ideal ruler who governs justly & is protector of Dharma
- moral principle govern method

- Sulh-i-kul (universal peace) + Din-i-Ilahi (Syncretic religion)
- Dharmasastra (Duties of kings)
 - ↳ maintain peace in kingdom
 - ↳ protect weak & push wrongdoers

include in law code

③ CALIPHATE (Khilafah)

- leadership of Muslim community
- legitimizing political authority → moral leadership by Mohammed
- Concepts —
 - ① Shura : consultation
 - ② Adl : justice
 - ③ Amanah : Trust
 - ④ Maslaha : Public welfare
 - ⑤ Sharia : Islamic law
 - ⑥ Hisbah : accountability
 - ⑦ Khilafah : Stewardship
 - ⑧ Bay-ah : oath of Allegiance

Led to success of
Islamic Golden Age

★ LINEARITY IN MEDIEVAL RULERSHIP

- Latinized concept created linearity
- Structured progression of power
 - ↳ linearity = structured, predictable path of succession & governance in medieval rulership
- Centralized Authority
 - ↳ consolidating power over various territories & reducing the local lord's influence
- Succession law via Primogeniture
 - ↳ First born son inherits the throne
 - ↳ Weaknesses : led to power disputes in case there's no clear heirs / when events did not follow expected linear path

- Consolidation of Royal Power

- ↳ by bringing more territories under direct royal control

- Royal charters & law

- ↳ Common law under centralised royal authority

- ↳ "Magna Carta" : ลดทอน king าลง

- ↳ evolution of legal & political power in England

- ↳ limiting king's power + laying ground work of
Constitutional governance

(Charlemagne, Justinian I)

- Dynastic Expansion

- ↳ expansion of royal power → growth of dynasties
↳ applicable to nobles & clergy too!

- ★ CHARISMATIC LEADERSHIP

- ① Personal Magnetism : inspire loyalty through personality

- ② Visionary : Articulates compelling solutions to challenges

- ③ Emotional appeal : Mobilizes followers emotionally → strong commitment

- ④ Crisis Leadership : Emerges forcefully in times of crisis
↳ decisive direction

- ⑤ Personal sacrifice : Willing to endure hardship for the greater good

- ⑥ Impact of authority & governance

- ⑦ Legitimization of authority : Use personal charisma & perceived
divine right to legitimatise their authority

- ⑧ Unifying realm : instrumental in unifying their realms, particularly
in times of war

- ⑨ Dynastic influence : trajectory of their dynasties / states

★ Medieval period has 2 characteristics

- ① Decline in literacy rate
 - ② Fragmentation from long time charisma
- key political persona / device
- ↳ adopted by leaders & became blueprint for many political personalities & systems

★ POWER VS. LEGITIMACY

- Power only becomes legitimate when there is a balance developed from time, geography and context
 - Power → ability to control others
 - Legitimacy → acceptance + belief that ruler has right to govern
 - Authority → formal / recognized right to exercise power
 - Too much power no legitimacy !
 - ↳ fragile, volatile, non-resilient over time
 - ↳ Power > authority → work as a means to handle "abnormal" circumstances ← disaster
war
 - Too much authority no power !
 - ↳ nothing gets enforced even if it's on paper
 - ↳ no trust + poor social condition
- * Measurement of power in states
- } Economic is power
- = ability to tax & increase tax revenue *

* DOMINUS MUNDI (LORD OF THE WORLD) & IMPERIAL SOVEREIGNTY

• Emperor's sovereignty ✓

↳ used by emperors to claim superiority over all other kings & rulers

↳ Roman notion → emperor as the supreme authority over the entire civilized world

• Debate: empire → singular, unlimited sovereign entity

OR

collection of territorially limited sovereign states

↳ legitimacy of state authority ① territorial control (power)

② Legal recognition (authority)

• DE FACTO EMPIRE

→ 2nd POWER

↳ legitimately powerful empires

↳ enforce cohesive culture, homogeneous identity & centralized top down control

NATION-CENTRIC

↳ Work theoretically but even Roman never truly a singular & unlimited sovereign power

↳ has control over territories / people / gov. regardless official recognition

• DE IURE EMPIRE

→ 2nd Authority

↳ collective territories w/ limited sovereign state

↳ administration is largely decentralized + reliant on regional power

↳ legal & official recognition of sovereignty → accepted by society

↳ from other states / int. law / int. legal framework

↳ Rulers hold formal titles, authority enforced by laws, constitutions, treaties

RECOGNITION

DE FACTO

Authority is recognized in practice

DE IURE

Authority is recognized by law

CONTROL

DE FACTO

Control exercised through force, influence, occupation

DE IURE

Control is exercised w/ legal legitimacy & recognition

STABILITY & LEGITIMACY

DE FACTO

May be seen as illegitimate

↳ leaves room for policy instability

DE IURE

More stable & legitimate

IMPORTANT

most political entities are never mutually exclusive de facto or de iure → bit of them both

* An empire might start as a de facto entity & later become de iure OR might lose de iure status and continue to exercise de facto over areas

* KEY TO UNDERSTAND nature of authority, legitimacy, sovereign

★ INFLUENCE ON STATE BUILDING & SOVEREIGNTY

- Roman law as a foundation
 - ↳ Corpus Legis civilis provided legal framework
 - ↳ formation of legal states
 - ↳ Monarchs used Roman rules to legitimize their rule
- Balance between church & state
 - ↳ Plenitudo Potestatis + imperium
 - ↳ solution to papacy vs. ruler conflict
 - ↳ notion of sovereignty as a balance between
spiritual & temporal powers

★ MEDIEVAL FOUNDATIONS OF INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS & LAWS

- REALISM : โลก + วัตถุอยู่จริง & เป็นอิสระจากจิตใจผู้รับรู้
 - ↳ Universal (justice, truths, law) exist independently of human thought & are grounded in the higher, divine reality
 - ↳ Belief that European norms & values were
Universally applicable → justifies colonialism
 - ↳ Natural laws by Thomas Aquinas
 - ↳ God has eternal law, which human should participate in it
 - ↳ Pursue goods, avoid evil
 - ↳ Universalism + Eurocentrism

Based on universal
accessible through
reasons & grounded
in divine order

→ Relativism

• NOMINALISM: ทหาไม่มีเลย, หรือถ้าไม่ได้สร้างกฎ มนุษย์เป็นคนหนึ่ง

↳ Universals do not exist indepently of human thought

↳ Moral & legal principles comes from human agreement and understanding

↳ support more inclusivity of diverse cultural & legal traditions

↳ TWAIL: Third World approach to International law

★ PARIBILE INHERITANCE (ก. สืบทอดแบบแบ่งส่วน)

• lot of succession + political fragmentation

• later changed to primogeniture → better for centralized states

• Debates related political stability + centralization

★ THE NORMAN CONQUEST

• Important in European history

• Consolidation of English territory

• French + European court culture import + legal practice

• Centralisation of power 

• Domesday Book: book of landholding & resources survey across England → use for taxation

Curia Regis
(ราชสำนัก)

★ BLACK DEATH ARRIVAL

• Urban population doubled / tripled in Europe

↳ Huge economic growth, empowered local guilds + lords

↳ lords + kingdoms started fighting for resources

• Black death impacted urban centres

↳ higher wages in urban areas

↳ rural population become urbanized

★ GUILDS

- Become advanced after Black death

① CRAFT GUILDS

- associations of artisans & craftsmen

each craft has its own
guild

- Controlled quality of work, set prices, regulated working hours, oversaw training of apprentices

② MERCHANT GUILDS

- regulated trade, set rules for commerce

- Protected members' interests, sometimes held monopolies over certain goods

• Importance of guilds

↳ economic regulation

quality control

Price regulation

↳ training & apprenticeship

apprenticeship system
standardized training

↳ social + Political influence

social cohesion
Political power

↳ Monopolies + protectionism

market control

Defense against external threats

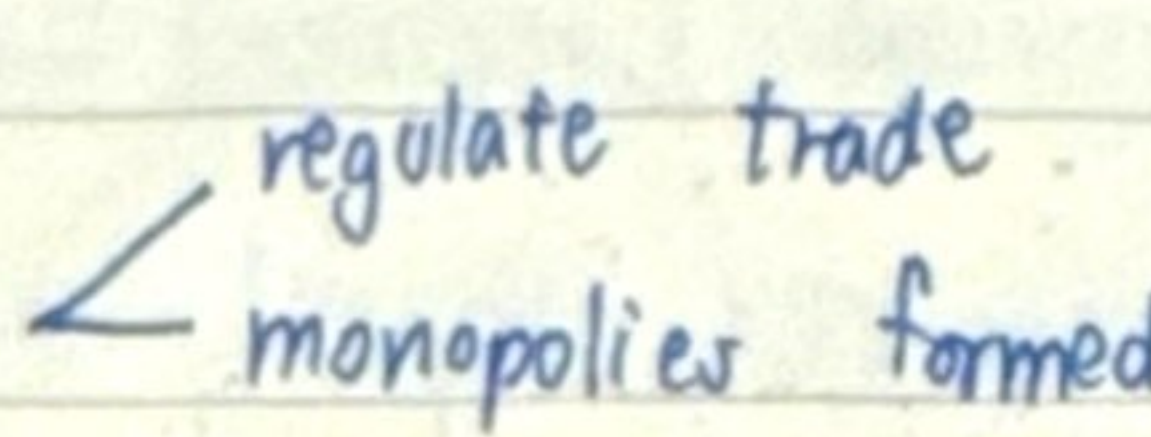
↳ cultural & Religious role

Patronage + charity

Guildhalls & symbols

- The idea surrounding moral authority and bounded authority had been around in antique empires
- ★ SOVEREIGN DEBT
- 1400: world hit "little ice age" → decline in productivity
 - European kings borrowed money to hire mercenaries
 - Papacy initiated several Crusades → costed lots of money
 - Sovereign debt increased rapidly across Europe
 - ↳ started in Italy
 - ↳ 'Prestiti' = loans to finance military campaigns
 - ↳ Wealthy citizens give loan → receive interest
 - ↳ Bonds could be traded among citizens
 - ↳ English & French monarch borrowing from wealthy families Italian banking houses
 - ↳ domestic sources + tallies later used to finance 100 Year's war
 - ↳ advancement of custom duties (and tarrifs) and direct taxes
 - State & crown had
 - ↳ level of sovereignty to engage in contracts
 - ↳ legal personhood of a state
 - ↳ continuity of sovereign obligations
 - Kings were finding themselves short of money
 - ↳ fight w/ nobles → Magna Carta
 - laws of Edward the confessor → limit royal power
- territorial & political authority
- ↳ Domesday book
- Laws were made, revised & updated as response to events
- Just + lawful rule

★ STABILITY IN EUROPE

- expansion of towns & cities
- North Europe started developing network via Hanseatic & North Sea network
- Guilds development 
 - ↳ Production guilds: people travelled to different places to learn craftsmanship 
- Production guilds found ways to mechanize production
- Port cities stop producing grain → import instead
 - ↳ Eastern Europe ex. Poland, Ukraine

★ APPROACHES TO FEUDALISM

- Generalization: some legal principles in the Libri Feudorum was integrated into the Corpus Iuris Civilis
 - ↳ 1135-1150: some legal principles in the Libri Feudorum was integrated into the Corpus Iuris Civilis
- Used to solve disputes over land tenure, vassalage & inheritance
- Manorialism: system of serfs → peasants tied to the land working in return for protection
- Vassalage: mutual relationship of loyalty & service → vassal & lords
- Fief: not just land, any form of gifts / objects / symbolic gesture
- There is some diff political org. that could be classed as within feudal scope → esp. places w/ strong Holy Roman Empire
- Economic → surplus by peasants in rural economies

★ 100 YEARS WAR

- Cause: English titles to French lands & control of Flanders
- Effect: French division w/ weakened fiscal power → no money from war
 - ↳ faced new threat in the East → Burgundy (Eng. allies)
- Henry VI proclaimed himself as king of France + Eng
 - ↳ not recognized by French people → no legitimacy
- Joan of Arc: United French people around the King
 - ↳ Support national identity
 - ↳ French victory @ Orleans 1429
- Result: permanent removal of England from French soil
 - ↳ except small portion of Calais
 - ↳ national armies paid by the state, no more mercenaries
 - ↳ taxes were raised
 - ↳ infantry (muskets) grew
 - ↳ formation of England & continental France

★ CENTRE OF GRAVITY

- 2 main usages for the concept

① Military legal concept

↳ law of place w/ closest connection to the conflicted place applies

↳ ใช้กฎหมายของระบบกฎหมายที่มีค.สัมพันธ์สำคัญที่สุดกับ conflict นั้น

② An idea links spatial average of the world together

↳ ค่าเฉลี่ยเชิงพื้นที่ + world economy

↳ Globalization

↳ changing political gravity → rush to understand non Global north narratives

★ RISE OF ISLAM & CALIPHATE SYSTEM

- Direct inheritors of Roman governance & legal tradition
 - Centerpiece for Islamic renewal → revival of caliphate
 - ↳ The most powerful advanced polity in Eurasia
 - Baghdad had huge areas w standing army + literate & numerate bureaucratic order
- constructed overcome after the death of Mohammad
- Caliphate system relies on an elected system from a selection of "qualified" candidates
 - ↳ later create schism (c. 1101/1102) between two Islamic strands

★ SINOSPHERE:

- civilization influenced by China
- Centralized bureaucracy w decentralized governance
(ระบบราชการแบบรวมศูนย์ที่กำกับดูแลแบบกระจายอำนาจ)
- Centralization paradox
 - ↳ centralizes meritocratic structure → ensure greater participation and function in governance
 - ↳ technocratic centralized bureaucracy also has its downfall
 - ↳ control over access to best education
 - ↳ informal bureaucracy emerge in places where bureaucracy doesn't exist to regulate ruler
 - ↳ money & long distance trade regulation
 - ↳ system of clientelism (ผู้อุปถัมภ์ & ผู้ถูกอุปถัมภ์)
 - ↳ Sinosphere state are busy w regulating affairs of state
 - ↳ commerce & trade deregulated & guilds emerged
 - ↳ neither individualistic / collective
 - ↳ neither completely open / close
 - ↳ not everyone can join but opp open to everyone
 - ↳ laws: emperor owns the lands at a symbolic level
 - ↳ citizens can private contract land & ownership
 - ↳ hoards too much land → political tension
 - ↳ Emperor's role: distribute welfare & wellbeing
 - ensure security
 - Allows land trade

defence
offence
security
public work

★ Huaxia (華夏)

shared language, customs, moral values

- early Chinese civilization & people who identified w a shared cultural & ethnic identity

↳ used to distinguish culturally advanced & settled people of the Central Plains from "barbarian" tribes

↳ Overtime include those who shared cultural identity regardless specific geographic region

↳ broader sense of unified Chinese civilization!

• Citizenship

→ + idea of sovereignty

↳ less about individual rights

↳ Participating in cultural & social life, fulfilling one's role in the community → Confucian principles

↳ Merit & social responsibility

↳ one's ability to contribute to society

education

confucian ethics

↳ Good citizens: respecting authority, contributing to stability & prosperity of state

• Impact on modern Chinese identity

collective national identity

↳ shape modern Chinese national identity

↳ Modern China adapted to promote inclusiveness & unity among diverse ethnic groups within borders

• Global perspective

→ 中華文化

↳ cultural identity & statehood can intertwined

↳ contrast w western notions of citizenship

legal rights, individual freedom

★ TRIBUTARY SYSTEM

- acknowledged supremacy of Chinese emperor
 - ↳ offer tribute, receive protection, trade benefits, recognition
- Maintain stability & peace in East asia by establishing clear hierarchical relationships
- Provide framework for solving dispute w/ out warfare
- Diplomatic precedent
 - ↳ soft power
 - ↳ cultural diplomacy
 - ↳ Sinocentric world order → china center

★ LEGACY + IMPACT

- End of system (19th century)
 - ↳ West power & Japan challenged China
- Long term influence
 - ↳ lasting impact on East Asian diplomacy
 - ↳ Now, China still views its role as Asia's leading power

★ CONCEPTUAL FRAMEWORK

① EMPIRE VS. NATION-STATES

- Traditional China viewed themselves as empire

↳ Empire: have hierarchical structure centered around
Core region

↳ Nation states: horizontal org. of power

↳ decentralized decision making

② CORE VS. PERIPHERY

- In the wall: core region
- Outside the wall: periphery (外圍)

③ HISTORICAL RESPONSE TO CHALLENGE

- Chinese empire's longevity & adaptability

↳ come from invasions, internal rebellions & significant
social & economic changes

④ ROLE OF PERIPHERY

- Source of change: periphery → frontlines to interact w/
non chinese entities → Bring new ideas, techs, practices
- ↳ Multiculturalism

⑤ Shifts in 19th century

- China's coastal fringe

↳ increased maritime trade, European colonial

- New centre of economic/exchange

↳ China's modernisation efforts & interaction w/ global
community

Shanghai
Guangzhou